

Old Testament Books mnemonics

A good way to memorize the **39 books of the Old Testament** is to learn them in groups rather than as one long list.

1. Law (5 books)

Genesis, Exodus, Leviticus, Numbers, Deuteronomy

Mnemonic:

God's Eternal Law Needs Devotion

(G E L N D)



2. History (12 books)

Joshua, Judges, Ruth, 1 Samuel, 2 Samuel, 1 Kings, 2 Kings, 1 Chronicles, 2 Chronicles, Ezra, Nehemiah, Esther

Mnemonic

Jolly Judges Read
1S 2S 1K 2K 1C 2C
Every Nation's Events

Or remember the pattern:

- Joshua
- Judges
- Ruth
- Samuel (1–2)
- Kings (1–2)
- Chronicles (1–2)
- Ezra
- Nehemiah
- Esther



3. Poetry/Wisdom (5 books)

Job, Psalms, Proverbs, Ecclesiastes, Song of Solomon

Mnemonic:

Joyful People Praise Every Savior

(J P P E S)



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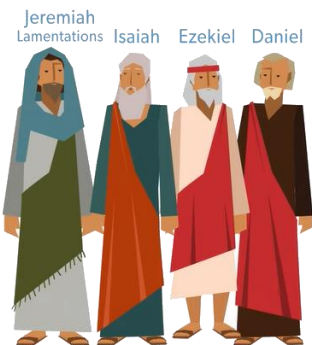
🔥 4. Major Prophets (5 books)

Isaiah, Jeremiah, Lamentations, Ezekiel, Daniel

Mnemonic:

I Just Love Every Day

(I J L E D)



🌿 5. Minor Prophets (12 books)

Hosea, Joel, Amos, Obadiah, Jonah, Micah, Nahum, Habakkuk, Zephaniah, Haggai, Zechariah, Malachi

A common mnemonic uses the initials:

H J A O J M N H Z H Z M

A memorable sentence is:

Happy Jellyfish Always Offer Juicy Mangoes.
Never Hesitate; Zebras Happily Zigzag Morningly.



Complete Order

Group	Books
Law (5)	Genesis, Exodus, Leviticus, Numbers, Deuteronomy
History (12)	Joshua, Judges, Ruth, 1–2 Samuel, 1–2 Kings, 1–2 Chronicles, Ezra, Nehemiah, Esther
Poetry (5)	Job, Psalms, Proverbs, Ecclesiastes, Song of Solomon
Major Prophets (5)	Isaiah, Jeremiah, Lamentations, Ezekiel, Daniel
Minor Prophets (12)	Hosea, Joel, Amos, Obadiah, Jonah, Micah, Nahum, Habakkuk, Zephaniah, Haggai, Zechariah, Malachi



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🎵 Easy Rhythm (39 books)

You can also chant them in this rhythm:



Genesis, Exodus, Leviticus, Numbers, Deuteronomy

Joshua, Judges, Ruth

First and Second Samuel

First and Second Kings

First and Second Chronicles

Ezra, Nehemiah, Esther

Job, Psalms, Proverbs, Ecclesiastes, Song of Solomon

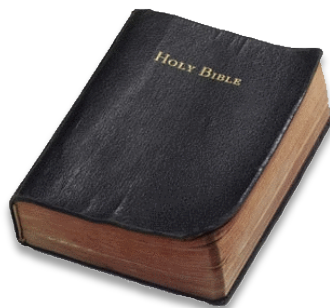
Isaiah, Jeremiah, Lamentations, Ezekiel, Daniel

Hosea, Joel, Amos, Obadiah

Jonah, Micah, Nahum, Habakkuk

Zephaniah, Haggai, Zechariah, Malachi

Learning the 5 groups (5-12-5-5-12) first makes memorizing all 39 books much easier.



*Thy word is a lamp unto my feet
and a light unto my path.*

– Psalms 119:105

